

Broken Tech

I RECENTLY GOT ZUCKED FOR 30 DAYS.

Zucked, metapaused, ban hammered, etc., are all slang for being banned from using Facebook, or as they put it, I got my "Account Restricted" for not following community guidelines. And what was my horrible crime? The terrible and abusive words I said? In the aftermath of the Texas mass shooting where 19 innocent children were killed, I responded to someone who was drawing a parallel between guns and hammers, and said "Not hammers, give them all nukes. Let's see how that works out."

There are literally calls for genocide that are allowed to stay up on Facebook because they do follow community standards, and an off the cuff remark from me sets the Facebook bots into overdrive!

All of this only started when I called someone a "silly goose" as per their request, to show me how idiotic the Facebook AI is when it comes to banning people. Yes, I actually got a warning for "bullying" and "harassment", for saying, "You silly goose!" to someone, who asked me to call them that in the comment above mine! And once the bot was onto me, I was doomed! I get warnings for older comments, for simple responses to people, and discussion is just impossible on that platform for me anymore because of either a broken AI, or moderators who just do not understand context, or even English for that matter.

I'm sure many of you are facing the same idiocy, and if you aren't, you can always join the club by finding me on Facebook and calling me a silly goose!

Facebook is dying. People are moving away from the platform, and new signups are not as good as before. It registered a stalling of growth in 2021, and a decline of daily logins as well. Share prices plummeted from nearly 400 USD at its peak in 2021, to just under 200 as I write this. There are a myriad of reasons why, but some important ones are that younger people think it's uncool, and the older people who are there hate the over-policing.

Plus, since Facebook makes no tangible product, they have no customer service to speak of. No customer service means a lack of redressal of grievances, and no company

survives for too long after they stop listening to their customers. Then again, the advertiser is actually Meta's customer, while we are just the product, whose data is sold to said customer!

It's not just Facebook, it's also Twitter who is in the same boat. Their algorithm and way of functioning made it far easier for bots and fake accounts to rule the conversation. As I write this, Elon Musk seems to be backing away from the offer he made to buy twitter outright and take it private. Why? Because there are way too many bots and not enough people, which makes the platform easier to manipulate.

And it's not just these few companies that are broken, or suffering from broken tech, it's the entire internet, from the ground up. The internet is just the global networking of local networks, when looked at rather simplistically. Your home network connects to your local ISP's network, which connects to a larger ISP's network, and so on until you're able to reach literally any computer online from any ISP in the world. Now, of course there are far more complexities involved, and finding the fastest path through all of the connected networks is a challenge, and one which very large companies solve by placing a server really close to you – Google, Facebook, or OTT providers, for example.

And that's where the problems start. The internet isn't the great leveller we think it is. Your little company doesn't stand a chance at taking on one of the big internet companies because you don't have the kind of backend setups they can afford. Plus, the backbones themselves are owned by companies all of whom want to make a profit, so they're always going to favour the big guys, or are already owned by them. Sure there are internet exchange providers (IXPs) who are usually non-profits that manage the points at which all of the big providers and their networks meet, but that's not enough.

The internet needs to be owned by countries and their people. All of these big companies should be paying us (or paying tax) to use the internet, while it should be freely available to everyone. If the dream is still to actually make the internet the great leveller it should be... 



"Not hammers, give them all nukes. Let's see how that works out."



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